



Growfit Sports Academy NPC

In partnership with North Crest Primary School · Greater Durban

INTERNAL STRATEGY · 2027 SEASON

Growfit 2027: Brand, Partnerships & Finance Plan

One plan that connects every proposal, event and letter to a single goal: make the Growfit name known and trusted across Durban football, so that when people hear it, teams, businesses and funders already want to work with us.

1 goal

Visibility that builds trust, and trust that brings partners

R76,900

Core 2027 running cost, coverable from our own events

~R120,000

Sponsorship target to fund growth projects

For

Buhle Madlala · Sphe Mlotshwa · Khaya Madlala
and incoming committee members

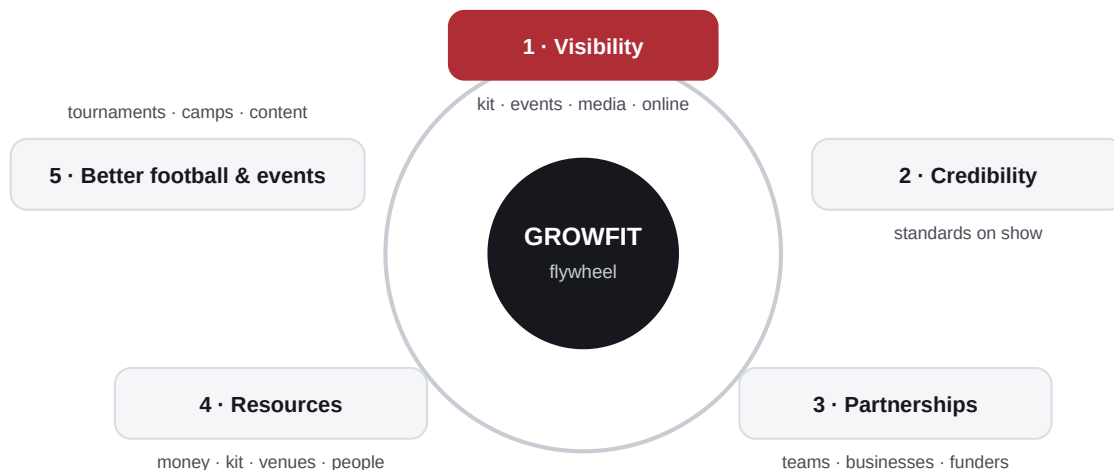
How to use

Read this first. Every other document is a tool for one part of this plan (Section 9 lists them). Figures are planning estimates, marked **[confirm]** where we need real numbers.

1 The objective, and how we get there

"When someone in Durban football hears 'Growfit', they should think: well run, good for kids, and worth partnering with."

Our strategy is to **put the Growfit brand in front of as many of the right people as possible, consistently, and to back it up with real standards.** Visibility alone fades. Visibility plus proof (well-run events, safe children, prizes paid on time, partners thanked in public) builds a reputation. A reputation makes every future conversation easier.



Five rules that decide everything else

1. **The Growfit name goes on everything:** kit, banners, posts, posters, letters, prizes, certificates.
2. **Show up consistently:** every match, every tournament, every week online. A modest presence every week builds more reputation than one big splash.
3. **Prove our standards in public:** safeguarding, consent, organised events, prizes paid on time, money reported.
4. **Make every partner look good:** thank them publicly, report to them on time, and connect them with each other.
5. **Sponsors fund growth, not survival.** Our own events cover the basics (Section 6), so no partner ever has to rescue us. That makes us more attractive to them.

2 Positioning: who we are, in one breath

Positioning statement. Growfit Sports Academy is a Durban non-profit football academy, run in partnership with North Crest Primary School, that develops U12–U17 players on and off the pitch to a professional standard: every child plays, every child is safe, and every partner is seen.

Tagline

"Growing players. Growing people."

RECOMMENDED

Uses our name, says development on and off the pitch, and works in English and as a short isiZulu line [e.g. "Sikhulisa abadlali. Sikhulisa abantu." Confirm with a first-language speaker] .

"Grow with Growfit."

Short and catchy. Good for social posts and sponsor messages ("Grow with Growfit, partner with us").

"Every child plays. Every child grows."

Strong for parents and schools. Puts fairness first.

Our story (use in every document, speech and post)

Founded in 2023 by **Buhle Madlala** with coaches **Sphe Mlotshwa** and **Khaya Madlala**, Growfit started with a simple belief: children from any background deserve football coached properly, safely and with ambition. Three years on, we run U12, U15 and U17 teams in the Greater Durban Football League, work with North Crest Primary School, and are building events (the Growfit Youth Cup, holiday camps and a national tour) that open doors for our players and our community.

Four message pillars

Development

Every child plays. Five development areas.
School comes first.

Standards

Safeguarding, consent,
SAFA registration, police-cleared coaches,
transparent money.

Community

North Crest, families, local businesses, partner clubs.
We bring people together.

Opportunity

Tournaments, scouts, a national tour. Football that opens doors.

How we sound

Warm, confident, proud of Durban and honest. We never exaggerate numbers, never single out a child as "needy", and always use first names only with consent.

3 Audiences: what each needs to hear

AUDIENCE	WHAT THEY CARE ABOUT	OUR MESSAGE	WHERE THEY SEE US
Parents & players	Safety, game time, development, cost, a path forward	"Every child plays and grows, in a club run properly."	WhatsApp channel, Facebook, matches, North Crest
Other clubs	Good fixtures, fair tournaments, respect	"Growfit events are organised, fair and worth entering."	League, Youth Cup, Challenge Series, coach WhatsApp
Businesses	Local customers, brand recall, B-BBEE, staff pride	"Your name where Durban's families look every week, and we prove it."	Partnership summary, prospectus, Youth Cup, LinkedIn
Schools & LFA	Safe programmes, participation, standards	"A reliable partner that lifts youth football in the area."	North Crest, school visits, GDLFA meetings
Funders & government	Impact, governance, accountability	"Measurable impact, clean books, real reach."	Grant applications, impact report
Media	Local stories, faces, results	"Durban kids making it happen."	Press releases, event invites

4 What we offer: the Growfit line-up

PRODUCT	WHAT IT DOES FOR THE BRAND	TOOL (DOCUMENT)
League teams (U12, U15, U17)	Weekly visibility in front of the same families and clubs, and the base of everything else.	Media kit
Growfit Youth Cup (×2 a year)	Our flagship. Brings 24–48 teams, 1,100+ people and businesses to <i>our</i> event. Pays for itself, with winner's vouchers of up to R7,500.	Youth Cup editions, posters
Outside tournaments (~9 entries)	Our badge on new stages every month. Funded by the Tournament Entry Partner.	Prospectus
Challenge Series	Relationships with top Durban clubs, so Growfit is seen as a peer.	Friendlies proposal
Holiday camps (×3–4)	New families, recruitment and income. Puts the brand on T-shirts across Durban.	Camps proposal
Gauteng Tour	National stage and a great story for sponsors and media. Only goes ahead if funded.	Tour proposal
Content & media	Makes everything above visible to people who weren't there.	Section 5, match camera proposals
Partner network	Directory, breakfasts, family offers. Partners gain from each other, which keeps them with us.	Prospectus, playbook

5 Marketing plan

A. Brand toolkit (build once, use everywhere)

- ✓ Logo files (PNG, transparent, vector), colours (red, black, white), one font family
- ✓ Canva templates: match day, result, player of the match, partner spotlight, event poster
- ✓ Pull-up banner + a 2 × 3 m **photo-wall backdrop** with partner logos
- ✓ Gazebo and flags in Growfit colours for every match and tournament
- ✓ Email signature, letterhead, WhatsApp business profile
- ✓ Google Business profile ("Growfit Sports Academy, Durban North") with photos and reviews
- ✓ One link-in-bio page: registration, partner info, events, donate
- ✓ Kit and team wear: the Growfit crest always more prominent than any partner logo

B. Social media: focus beats spread

For grassroots clubs the proven approach is **two main platforms**, posting **3–5 times a week, consistently**. A slightly blurry photo every week beats a perfect graphic once a month. **Facebook** reaches parents and the community. **Instagram, with reels cross-posted to TikTok**, reaches players and the wider public. A **WhatsApp channel** reaches every family directly.

DAY	CONTENT
Sunday	Match day: line-ups, live score updates, final result graphic
Monday	Player of the Match (consented, first name only) and a highlight clip
Wednesday	Training clip or skill of the week. Coach tip
Friday	Partner Spotlight, or the countdown to the next event
Monthly	Behind the scenes, a North Crest moment, a thank-you to all partners, a recruitment post

Best times: 08:00–10:00 and 18:00–21:00. Small targeted adverts (about R300 a month, people within 10 km of North Crest) around registration, camps and the Youth Cup. Children appear only with media consent and never with full names. Realistic year-1 target: about 200 posts and about 150,000 impressions, measured monthly.

C. Local media & PR

OUTLET	WHY	PITCH
Northglen News	Durban North's community paper: ~27,700 copies weekly, covers local sport and schools	Youth Cup, North Crest partnership, player profiles
Berea Mail and other local papers	Have covered the GDLFA and its sponsors	Results, tour send-off
Ukhozi FM (90.8)	South Africa's biggest radio station, Durban-based, isiZulu, with sport and community content	Tour story, Youth Cup, community impact
Gagasi FM (99.5) · DYR (105.1)	Durban youth-focused commercial and community radio	Event plugs, youth voices

Five press moments a year: season launch and kit reveal · Youth Cup announcement and results (×2) · Gauteng Tour send-off and return · end-of-season awards and impact numbers.

D. Community & word of mouth

- ✓ **North Crest:** free skills sessions at school, a presence at sports day, and Growfit news in the school newsletter (subject to approval)
- ✓ **Open trials and camp taster days** to bring in new families
- ✓ **Parents as ambassadors:** share-ready posts, a referral thank-you, and parents' businesses in the directory
- ✓ **Every opponent leaves with a good impression:** handshake line, a thank-you post that tags their club, fair play

E. What we measure every month

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Followers (FB + IG) and WhatsApp channel members

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Monthly reach and best-performing post

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Media mentions and event attendance

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Partner prospects contacted, met, signed

6 Finance: the whole 2027 picture

This puts every proposal into one budget. Separating **core running costs** (which our own activities should cover) from **growth projects** (which go ahead only when a partner funds them) keeps the academy safe and makes our sponsor pitch honest.

Core running costs (estimate)

SAFA / LFA registration & league affiliation	9,000 [confirm]
Transport to away league matches (~18 × R800)	14,400
Outside tournaments: ~7 regional entries incl. travel	28,000
Equipment: balls, bibs, cones, nets	8,000
Coach education & police clearances	6,000
Admin, data, printing, bank fees	6,000
Insurance	3,000
First aid & medical supplies	2,500
Core total	R76,900

Own income (base case)

Growfit Youth Cup × 2 (24-team, then 36-team edition)	6,000
Holiday camps × 3 (~R6,600 each)	19,800
Community fundraising (playbook, ~half of potential)	40,000
Donations & crowdfunding (not tour)	15,000
Member contributions (with hardship waivers)	[confirm]
Own income total	R80,800+

The core is covered by our own work (about +R3,900 before member contributions). Sponsorship therefore funds growth, which is a stronger story to tell partners.

Growth projects: only when funded

PROJECT	COST	FUNDED BY	TRIGGER
Team wear (tracksuits, training tops, bags)	30,000	Team Wear Partner	Partner signed
Social media & content manager (part-time, 12 months)	60,000	Digital & Content Partner	Partner signed
Match camera (XbotGo option)	29,700	Grant or Match Camera / Digital Partner	Funds in bank
Gauteng Tour 2027 (U15 + U17, by bus)	293,200	Tour sponsors, donations, families, events	85% raised by 8 weeks before

Three scenarios for 2027

SCENARIO	WHAT WE DO	SPONSORSHIP NEEDED	BRAND RESULT
Lean	League, outside tournaments, 2 Youth Cups, camps, volunteer social media	R0 (in-kind welcome)	Steady local visibility
Base TARGET	Lean + team wear + content manager + match camera	~R120,000	Professional, visible every week
Growth	Base + Gauteng Tour	~R120,000 + ~R190,000 tour	Regional and national profile

Money rules

- ✓ Separate tracking per project (tour, Youth Cup, camps), using a reference code on every payment
- ✓ Build a **reserve of 3 months' core costs (~R19,000)** before committing to new projects
- ✓ Two people approve every payment over R2,000. Two people count all cash
- ✓ Every partner gets a report showing how their money was spent. We publish a simple annual summary
- ✓ Tax status confirmed with an accountant (NPC/PBO, section 18A) before promising any tax benefit

7 Partnership pipeline

To raise about R120,000 at an average of about R20,000 per partner, we need **6 partners**. Typical conversion means about **70 contacts** → **24 meetings** → **6 partners**, plus in-kind supporters along the way.

PRIORITY	PACKAGE	BEST-FIT PROSPECTS
1	Tournament Entry Partner (R28,000)	Hollywood Foundation (renewal / upgrade), parents' employers, Toyota SA
2	Team Wear Partner (R30,000)	Mr Price Sport (via GDLFA), Totalsports, a local kit maker
3	Digital & Content Partner (R60,000)	Telecoms, banks and insurers, local media groups
4	Youth Cup Partner / Prize Partners	SPAR owners, drinks brands, car dealers, local businesses
5	Squad Partners and Sponsor a Player	Small businesses, parents' businesses, staff collections

8 2027 roadmap

Q4 2026 · Prepare Brand toolkit and templates · Google profile · WhatsApp channel · Hollywoodbets thank-you and next ask · venue booked for the December Youth Cup · first 20 sponsor contacts · Youth Cup #1 (Dec)	Q1 2027 · Launch Season launch and kit reveal (press) · registrations and open trials · Founding Partner deadline · Gauteng Tour go/no-go · camp (Mar/Apr) · Northglen News feature	Q2 2027 · Build League and outside tournaments · Challenge Series fixtures · quiz or braai night · grant applications · first quarterly partner reports	Q3 2027 · Peak Winter Youth Cup #2 (Jul) and camp · corporate 5-a-side · mid-year impact post · renewals open for 2028
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Q4 2027: summer Youth Cup, camp, end-of-season awards, annual impact report, 2028 partner renewals. Exact dates follow the GDFL and KZN school calendars.

Who owns what

AREA	OWNER
Strategy, partnerships (lead), finance sign-off, football standards	Buhle Madlala
Fundraising, registration, partner pipeline and reports	Khaya Madlala
Operations, equipment, event logistics, admin	Sphe Mlotshwa
Safeguarding lead · Programmes & Camps · Logistics	Open seats: recruit in Q4 2026
Social media & content	Volunteer parent now. Paid manager once the Digital Partner signs

9 Your toolkit

NEED	USE
First contact with a business	Partnership Summary (2 pages) + cold email O1 from the Prospectus
Sponsor meeting	Prospectus + Media Kit + meeting plan O5 and objection answers O6
Who to approach, letters by type	Sponsor Prospects & Letters (L1–L11)
Closing and after-care	Commitment form O7 → agreement S5 → B-BBEE letter S6 → thank-you S7
Hosting the Youth Cup	24-, 36- or 48-team edition + posters
Other events and funds	Tour, Friendlies, Camps, Playbook, Donations & Grants
Match video	XbotGo (affordable) or Veo proposals

10 Risks to the brand, and how we protect it

Over-promising	We use honest, measured numbers, label targets as targets, and only offer what we can deliver every week.
A badly run event	Go/no-go checks, run of show, volunteer roster and the standards in the Youth Cup plans. Better to postpone than run a poor event.
Safeguarding incident	Appoint the Safeguarding Officer before the first Youth Cup. Consent register, police-cleared adults, a clear reporting route.
Money questions	Separate project tracking, two signatures, reports to partners, an annual summary.
Volunteer burnout	Fill the three open seats, recruit a parents' committee, and pay stipends for camps and filming jobs.
Betting partner perception	Name and logo only on children's kit, nothing at school, adult-only activations. Explain this calmly when asked.

11 The next 30 days

1. Agree the tagline and story (Section 2). Make the Canva templates and photo-wall backdrop.
2. Set up the Google Business profile, WhatsApp channel and link-in-bio page. Start posting 3–5 times a week.
3. Thank Hollywoodbets publicly. Ask permission to name them, and submit the next Hollywood Foundation request (L1).
4. Confirm the North Crest partnership scope with the principal.
5. Choose the Youth Cup size (start with the 24-team edition, then grow to 36 or 48). Book the venue (Northwood Crusaders or Siripat) and open entries.
6. Build a list of 70 prospects, starting with parents' employers. Send the first 20 summaries.
7. Fill in placeholders: bank details, NPC/PBO numbers, real costs, coach roles.
8. Pitch Northglen News on the Youth Cup and the North Crest partnership.

Sources for marketing practice and media: grassroots social media guidance (Kent FA, TeamSnap, Pembee), Northglen News (Caxton), Ukhozi FM, Gagasi FM, DYR 105.1. Venue cost reference: eThekweni Chatsworth Stadium tariff (IOL, 2024).